

Where is AI actually making money?

Using 1,000 TrustMRR startups to separate commercial signal from startup noise—and frame the next geography decision.

1,000

startups

197

AI listings

0.91

MRR ↔ subscriptions

Decision lens: Where should a large conglomerate investigate AI expansion next?

The dataset says three things—and one thing it cannot yet say.

01 AI is the largest identified category

197 listings—~20% of the full sample.

02 The market is power-law, not average

Median MRR is \$282 vs. \$13.5K mean.

03 Paying customers beat popularity

Subscriptions ↔ MRR = 0.91; followers ↔ MRR = 0.02.

04 Geography needs a second layer

Startup counts alone cannot prove the best country.

Implication: use TrustMRR to shortlist and validate commercial traction—not to declare a geography winner prematurely.

TrustMRR converts startup activity into observable commercial signals.

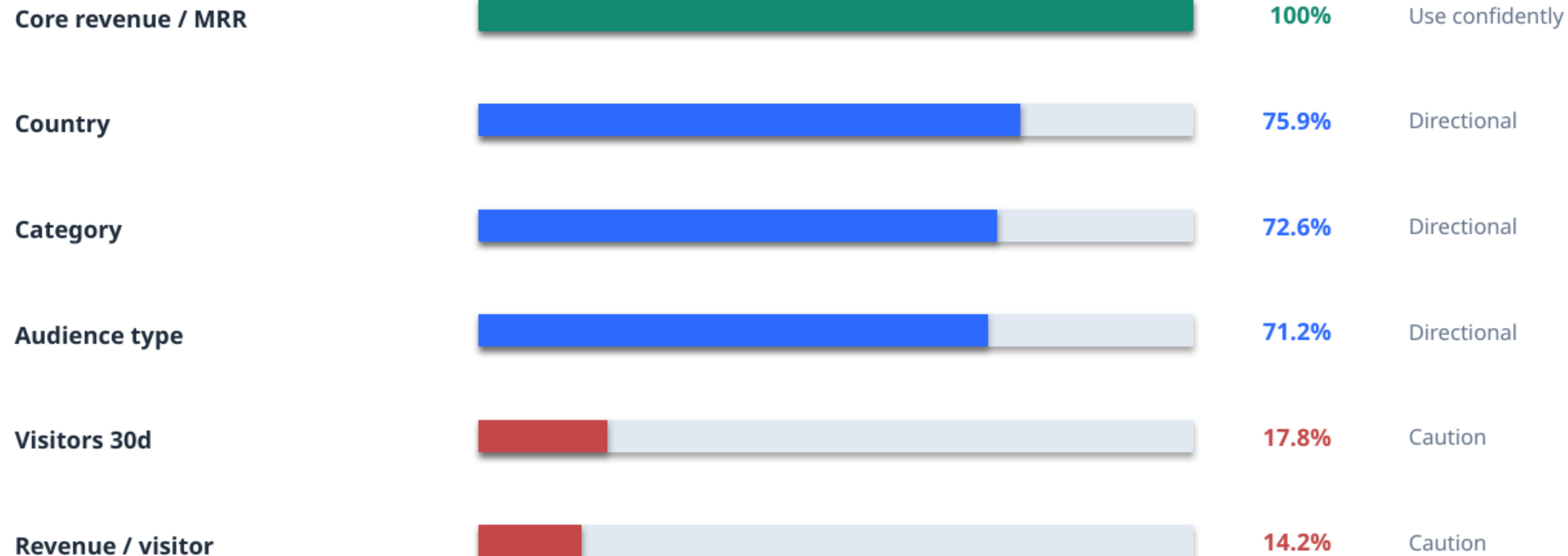
The core money fields are complete across all 1,000 rows.



Can revenue evidence reveal where commercially validated AI businesses are emerging?

Strong on money. Weak on marketing.

That determines what we should—and should not—conclude.



Use TrustMRR as a commercial-validation dataset—not as a complete demand or traffic dataset.

The 'average startup' barely exists.

Mean values are pulled upward by a small number of breakout winners.

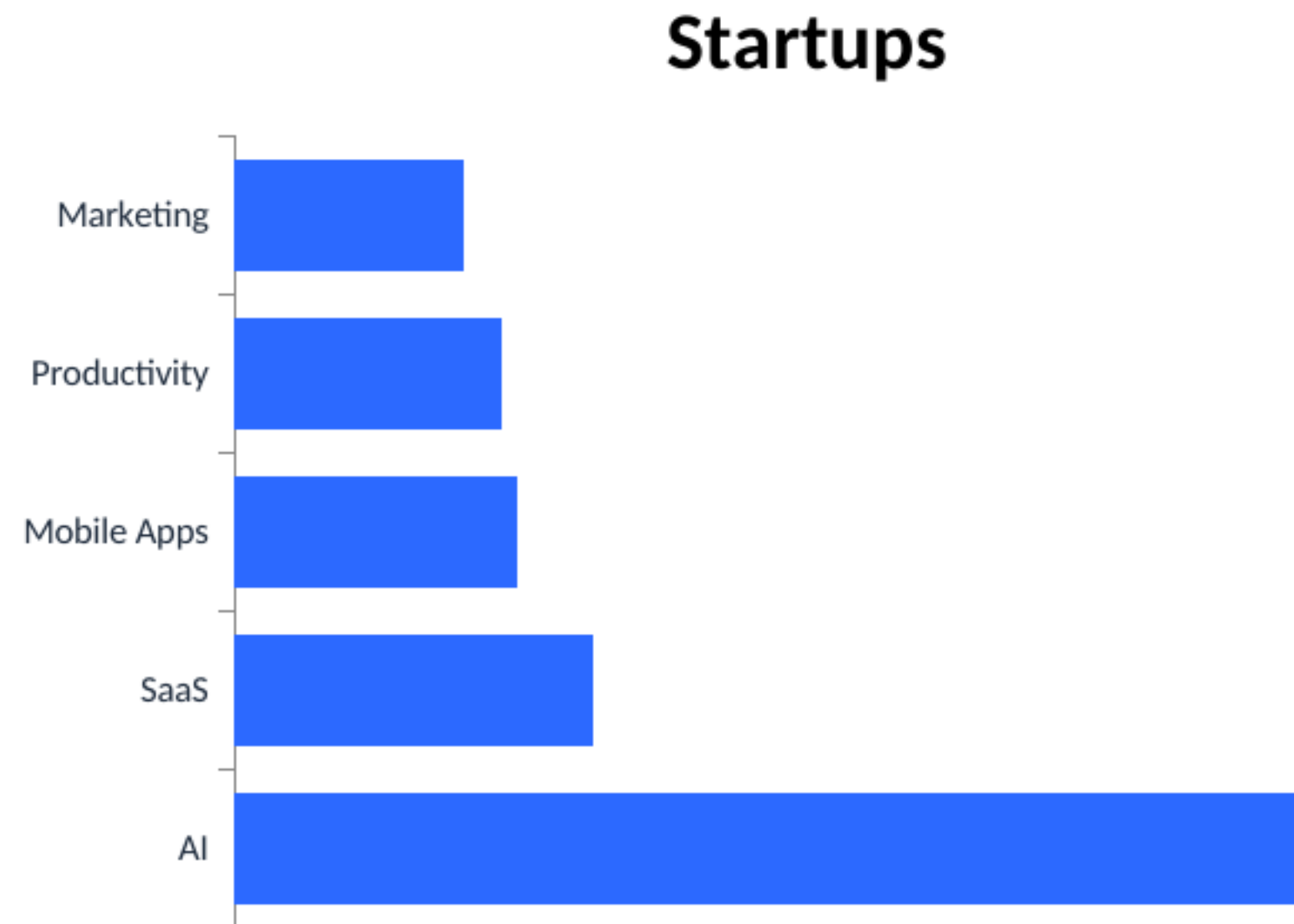


Many experiments. Few breakout winners.

Strategic implication: benchmark winners separately; ecosystem averages are not a typical launch outcome.

AI is already the largest startup formation category.

The question is no longer whether AI exists—it is where monetisation is durable.



197

AI listings

~1 in 5

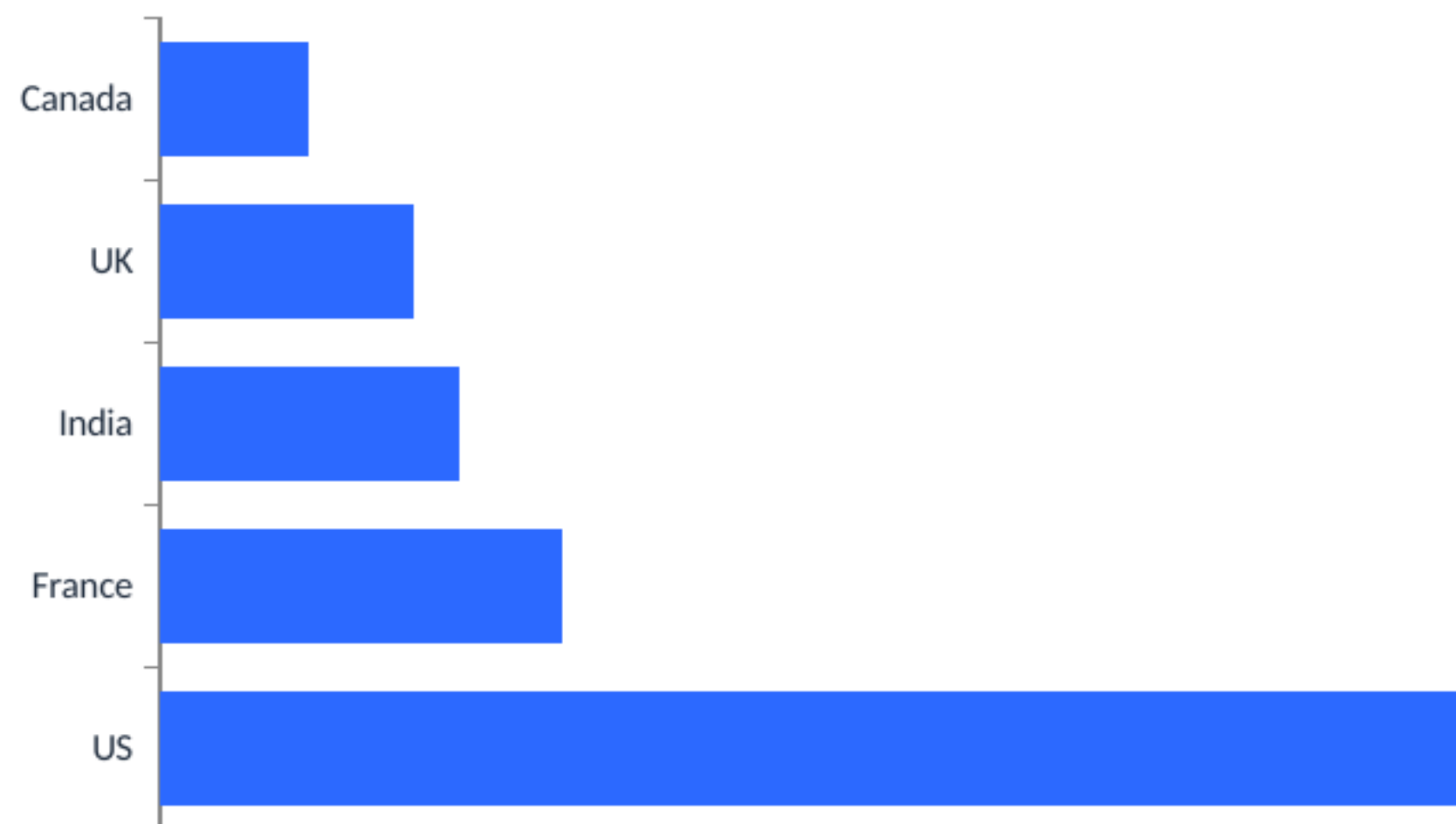
of all 1,000 TrustMRR listings

**Which AI business models and geographies
convert this activity into recurring revenue?**

The US leads startup representation—but count is not attractiveness.

65 countries appear in the data; 24.1% of country values are missing.

Startups



258

US listings

Missing from this study guide:

- AI MRR by country
- AI growth by country
- AI subscription depth by country
- Market size / regulation

Shortlist with TrustMRR; select with deeper country diligence.

Customers predict revenue. Followers don't.

The strongest relationship in the dataset is between subscriptions and MRR.

0.91

MRR ↔ active subscriptions

The clearest commercial validation signal.

Revenue ↔ MRR



0.87

Revenue ↔ subscriptions



0.80

Domain rating ↔ revenue



0.28

Followers ↔ revenue



0.02

Followers ↔ MRR



0.02

For AI market entry, prioritise paying-customer evidence over social buzz.

The upside is real—but concentrated.

Two explicitly identified AI companies appear among the top five MRR businesses.

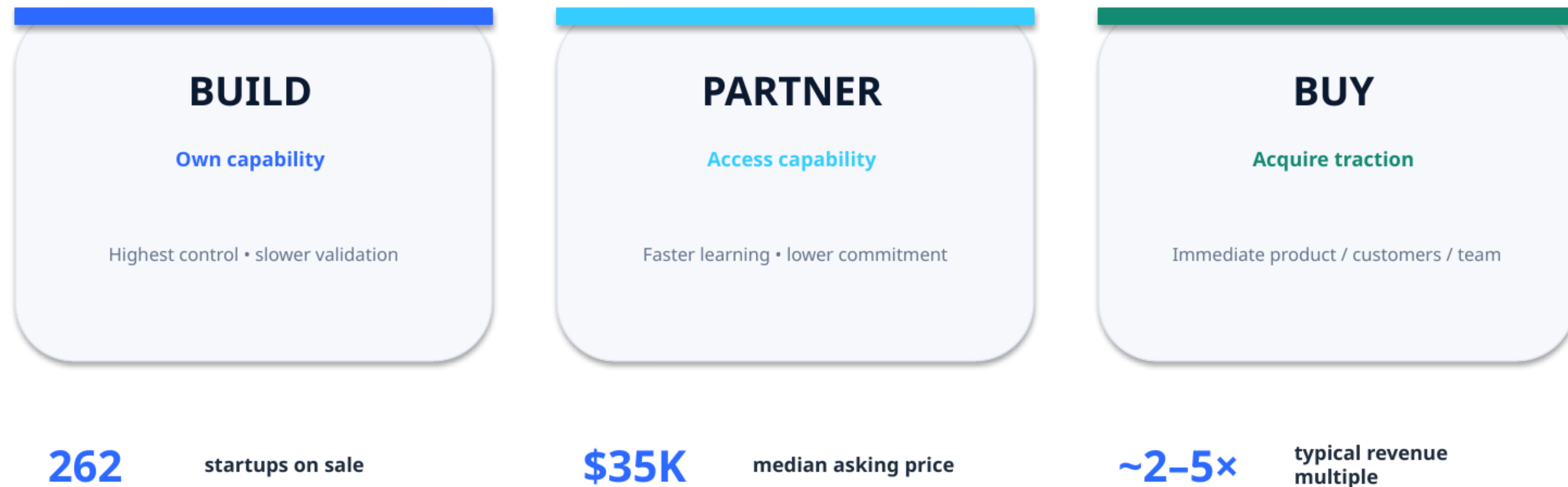


\$282 median MRR → **\$3.57M maximum MRR**

Scale is possible; it is not evenly distributed.

A conglomerate does not have to build from zero.

26.2% of TrustMRR startups are marked 'on sale'.



Turn TrustMRR into an AI Geography Attractiveness Score.

Commercial evidence should be the anchor—not the entire answer.



ADD OUTSIDE TRUSTMRR

- Market size
- AI regulation
- Talent
- Cloud economics
- Enterprise demand
- Localisation
- Privacy / data

Don't follow where AI is loudest.

Follow where customers are already paying.

AI

197 listings → largest category

ECONOMICS

\$282 median MRR → power-law

SIGNAL

0.91 subscriptions ↔ MRR

GEOGRAPHY

Shortlist now; diligence next

Recommended next move: calculate AI-specific country economics before selecting the market.